# TBRI® TRUST-BASED RELATIONAL INTERVENTION®

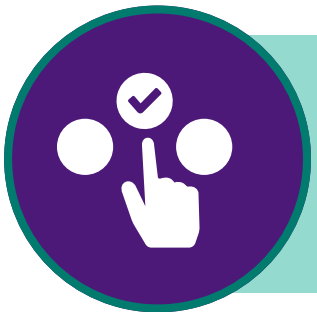
# Levels of Response

TBRI Levels of Response offer structured guidance for caregivers dealing with challenging behavior in children and youth. This approach promotes positive behavior and ensures that even difficult situations become learning opportunities. The TBRI Levels of Response help caregivers maintain a balance of structure and nurture in addressing behavior challenges.



## LEVEL 1: PLAYFUL ENGAGEMENT

- Use when child/youth briefly answers back, rolls eyes, and is demanding.
- Use warm tone, moderate volume, and a quick, playful cadence.
- Use *Life Value Terms*.
- Adult's Goal: Playfulness



## LEVEL 2: STRUCTURED ENGAGEMENT

- Use when the actions of the child/youth escalates.
- Tone is lower and firmer; cadence is slow, and volume is a little louder.
- Use *Choices and Compromises*.
- Adult's Goal: Structuring child's thought process



## LEVEL 3: CALMING ENGAGEMENT

- Use when child/youth is dysregulated.
- Tone should be firm, cadence slow, and volume increased being mindfully aware of sensory input.
- Use calming strategies and *re-dos*.
- Adult's Goal: Emotional regulation



## LEVEL 4: PROTECTIVE ENGAGEMENT

- Use when child/youth exhibits dangerous behaviors.
- Use minimal words in a slow, low tone.
- Encourage regulation practices like deep breaths and wall push-ups.
- Adult's Goal: Behavioral regulation

TCU | KARYN PURVIS INSTITUTE of CHILD DEVELOPMENT EST. 2005

©2024 Karyn Purvis Institute of Child Development.